
ASSESSMENT REPORT

Technical Assessment

ShutUP Forwarder – AI-Powered Car Transport Marketplace

Praveen Kulkarni (Contractor)
10.08.2026

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Executive Summary

This report documents the results of the technical assessment at Praveen Kulkarni (Contractor) as part of the project *ShutUP Forwarder – AI-Powered Car Transport Marketplace*.

Key Findings:

- Deliverable is a demonstration prototype, not foundational engineering work
- Core features are simulated or hardcoded (photo upload disabled, fake driver uploads, hardcoded AI damage report)
- The contractor himself described the AI features as intentionally blank (email of 2026-06-15)
- Frontend and backend do not share contracts – the flagship workflows cannot function against real server data
- No dedicated backend, no UI library, no migrations, no audit trail, no observability, no payments
- Build pipeline runs `prisma db push --accept-data-loss` – data loss codified into deployment
- Short July development burst (30 commits, one developer) with no planning artifacts and no CI/CD; rebranded leftovers from another market
- Six-week engagement with allocated resources never performed – no further development resources were made available
- Developers agreed in the July meeting to be presented in August were never provided – repeated requests on 3–5 August and the Friday 07.08.2026 deadline received no response
- Instead of developers, only a management handover was proposed – a friend who is 'not available for hire' and would manage the project 'as a favor'
- The contractor's own promise to 'get the foundation right first' (email of 2026-06-23) is unmet – the deliverable shows no platform foundation: no component system, no dedicated backend, no migrations, no CI/CD
- The client offered to cooperate and mentor the developers (08.07.2026), but no developer was ever presented for a technical interview – all contact ran exclusively through the contractor
- Deliverable provides no usable foundation for the intended platform

The refund demand and the bank details for the settlement are documented in chapter 6.

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Scope of Investigation

I 2.1 Assessment Scope

The assessment covered the following areas:

- Static analysis of the full repository (SvelteKit app + landing page, 30 commits, ~9,400 lines of TypeScript/Svelte)
- Verification of every marketed feature against actual code (photos, AI damage detection, compliance documents, payouts, notifications)
- Contract review between frontend and backend (status enums, API payloads, data flow)
- Data model review (Prisma schema, migrations, seeding behaviour)
- Build and deployment pipeline review (package.json scripts, git history)
- Engineering process review (git history: commits, authors, planning artifacts)
- Fit-for-purpose assessment against the stated project goal

I 2.2 Methodology

Static engineering assessment of the source repository, git history and build configuration performed on 2026-08-05. All findings were verified against the code itself, not against marketing documentation. Each dimension is rated on a scale of 1 (critical) to 5 (excellent).

I 2.3 Engagement & Deadline Timeline

The contractor was engaged from April 2026 to deliver the initial development for an AI-powered car transport marketplace ("ShutUP Forwarder") intended to serve as the foundation for a professional logistics platform. The contractor proposed a budget of € 2.000,00 for a six-week engagement (email of 2026-05-03) covering a minimal product with login, basic functionality on mock data, input forms and user types. The payment was received in May 2026 (confirmed by the contractor on 2026-05-26).

The engineering assessment of the delivered repository (static analysis of source code, git history, database schema and build pipeline) on 2026-08-05 concluded that the deliverable is a demonstration prototype, not foundational engineering work: core features are simulated or hardcoded, frontend and backend do not share contracts, there is no dedicated backend, no migrations, no audit trail, no observability, and the build pipeline is configured to allow data loss. 4 of 19 SaaS essentials are present. The contractor himself described the AI features as intentionally blank (email of 2026-06-15) and the earlier site as a mockup to attract investors (email of 2026-04-18). The promised six-week engagement with allocated resources was not performed: the repository shows a short development burst (2026-07-01 → 2026-07-11; 30 commits, 25 by a single developer and 5 by the contractor), and no further development resources were made available.

Resources were promised again for the beginning of August 2026 (message of 2026-07-18). Repository access, a deployment URL and test credentials were provided on 2026-07-06, and in the review meeting of 2026-07-07 the parties agreed that developers would be presented in August for the next development phase. None of these promises were kept: no developer was ever presented or made available for an interview. The client repeatedly offered to cooperate and to mentor the contractor's developers (message of 2026-07-08), but no developer was ever presented for a technical interview; all communication was conducted exclusively with the contractor. The client requested a meeting and developer interviews repeatedly on 3, 4 and 5 August 2026 and set an explicit final deadline: competent developers had to be presented for interview by Friday 07.08.2026, otherwise the contract would be considered breached and the refund process initiated. No response was received; the deadline passed without a developer being provided. Instead of developers, only a management handover was proposed: a friend of the contractor who is "not available for hire" and would coordinate the project "as a favor" (messages of 4 and 5 August 2026).

I 2.4 Contracted Scope & Delivery Gap

On 2026-05-03 the contractor proposed the engagement: "I suggest starting with a budget of 2000 Euros. For now, I need to engage some resources... a minimal product would be sufficient—something with a login screen, basic functionality using mock data, and deciding all input forms and types of users needed."

In context, this "minimal product" was the seed for the intended platform foundation, not a final deliverable. The contractor described the engagement as setting up "architecture and infrastructure" (email of 2026-05-01), promised to "make sure we get the foundation right first"

(email of 2026-06-23) and stated that "having workable proof of concept is important for long term success" (email of 2026-06-15). The engagement was therefore to produce a working, reviewable foundation for the platform — not a static mockup.

Agreed	Delivered
Six-week engagement with allocated resources	Short development burst 01–11 July 2026 (30 commits, one developer + contractor); no resources thereafter
Working technical foundation for the platform	Demo/prototype: no dedicated backend, no component system, no migrations, no CI/CD, no audit trail
Basic functionality with mock data (login, forms, user types)	Broken frontend/backend contracts; flagship workflow reads localStorage; AI features mocked or hardcoded
Development resources presented and coordinated with the client	No developer ever presented for an interview; only a manager 'not available for hire' was proposed

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Current State & Findings

I 3.1 Findings Overview

Dimension	Rating	Status
Deliverable Completeness	1/5	Critical
Architecture & Backend	1/5	Critical
Data Model & Persistence	1/5	Critical
Frontend/Backend Contracts	1/5	Critical
SaaS Foundation	1/5	Critical
Process & Delivery	1/5	Critical

I 3.2 Claimed vs. Delivered – Feature Verification

Feature	Expected	Observed	Location	Result
Photo upload & damage detection	User uploads photos; system detects damage	Upload module disabled per instructions; mock uploads only	frontend/src/routes/submit/photos/+page.svelte	Mocked / disabled
AI damage comparison at delivery	AI compares before/after photos	Fixed message written from a `damage=yes` URL parameter; no image analysis exists	frontend/src/routes/api/jobs/[job_id]/complete/+server.ts	Hardcoded
Price & distance estimation	Route-based price/distance calculation	Price derived from the sum of character codes of the address strings	frontend/src/routes/submit/route/+page.svelte	Placeholder arithmetic
Driver compliance documents (Code 95)	Upload and verification of driver documents	Fake upload with hardcoded filename 'Code95_Certificate_Verified.pdf'	frontend/src/routes/driver-compliance/apply/+page.svelte	Fake upload
Driver pickup/delivery photo flow	Photos captured and stored at pickup/delivery	Client-side simulation with timers flipping a boolean	frontend/src/routes/jobs/active/+page.svelte	Simulated
Real-time tracking / job status updates	Status driven by server data	Page checks snake_case statuses the server never produces; job loaded from local Storage with hardcoded status and payout	frontend/src/routes/jobs/active/+page.svelte	Broken contract
Payouts, ratings, notifications, What-sApp tracking, CMR waybills	Functional payment, rating, notification and documentation flows	Marketing copy only; no payment model, no notification system, no messaging infrastructure, no rating model	frontend/src/lib/translations.ts	Not implemented
AI validation of jobs/bids	AI validates and filters marketplace items	Valid stored but never used; AI failures silently accept jobs ('fallback validation mode active')	frontend/src/lib/server/ai/brokerAgent.ts	Decorative
Database foundation	Migratable, safe persistence layer	4 models, free-form status strings, zero migrations; production build runs `prisma db push --accept-data-loss`	frontend/prisma/schema.prisma · frontend/package.json	Data-loss risk
CMR waybills / document handling	Cross-border paperwork generated and checked automatically (as marketed)	Marketing copy only; no document handling code exists	frontend/src/lib/translations.ts	Not implemented

I 3.3 Deliverable Completeness

Rating: 1 – Critical

Findings:

- Photo upload & damage detection: disabled / mocked per instructions
- Driver pickup/delivery photo flow: client-side simulation with timers
- AI damage comparison: hardcoded string from a `damage=yes` URL parameter – no image analysis exists
- Price & distance estimation: placeholder arithmetic (sum of character codes of the address strings)
- Driver compliance documents (Code 95): fake upload with hardcoded filename
- Payouts, ratings, notifications, WhatsApp tracking, CMR waybills: marketing copy only, no implementation

NOTE

Recommendation: No component of the promised feature set was delivered as functional software.

I 3.4 Architecture & Backend

Rating: 1 – Critical

Findings:

- No dedicated backend – database access, AI calls and business logic all live in SvelteKit serverless route handlers
- No API service layer, no domain layer, no background workers/queues, no event bus
- Blocking synchronous AI calls with 12-second timeouts in serverless handlers
- No separate frontends per audience – customer, driver and admin are roles in one route tree gated by a localStorage value

NOTE

Recommendation: A professional foundation requires a dedicated backend, separate audience portals and a real component system.

I 3.5 Data Model & Persistence

Rating: 1 – Critical

Findings:

- Entire persistence layer: 4 models (User, Job, Bid, DriverRequest)
- Zero migration files – migrations were explicitly removed (commit 35dfe26)
- Production build runs `prisma db push --accept-data-loss` and re-seeds demo data on every deploy
- Job statuses are free-form strings – no enums, no state machine, no transition validation
- pgvector embedding column declared but never used anywhere

NOTE

Recommendation: The build pipeline must never be allowed to destroy data on deployment.

I 3.6 Frontend/Backend Contracts

Rating: 1 – Critical

Findings:

- Server job statuses are PascalCase; the driver page checks snake_case statuses the server never produces
- The flagship 'active load' page loads its job from localStorage, not from the API
- Hardcoded Indian Rupee payout (₹5,000) and US-only seed data for a product marketed as European
- Consequence: the flagship driver workflow cannot function against real server data – it only works as a scripted demo

NOTE

Recommendation: Frontend and backend must share contracts before any workflow can operate on real data.

I 3.7 SaaS Foundation

Rating: 1 – Critical

Findings:

- 4 of 19 SaaS essentials present; the present ones are table-stakes patterns (identity, validation, contract tests)
- No UI library or design system – exactly 2 shared components (Button, StatusBadge) across 21 Svelte files; the remaining UI is page-local markup with duplicated Tailwind classes and inline styles; no component primitives, no accessibility primitives
- Missing: dedicated backend, per-audience portals, UI library, migrations, audit trail, observability, rate limiting, payments, notifications, media storage, multi-tenancy, CI/CD, i18n tooling
- Auth is outsourced to Clerk with client-side user provisioning – no webhooks, local-Storage role checks

NOTE

Recommendation: The foundation layer of a professional product does not exist.

I 3.8 Process & Delivery

Rating: 1 – Critical

Findings:

- 30 commits in 11 days (01–11 July 2026); 25 of 30 by a single developer, 5 by the contractor – a short two-person sprint, not a team
- No planning artifacts (no ADRs, no architecture or design documents)
- Full-stack pivot mid-sprint; the backend was later abandoned entirely
- Deploy-by-commit, no CI/CD; data loss knowingly codified ('fix: allow prisma db push data loss for vercel build')
- Mocked features committed as features; rebranded leftovers (₹5,000 payout, US seed data)

NOTE

Recommendation: The delivery process does not support the claim of professional engineering work.

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Recommendations

I 4.1 Prioritized Measures

No.	Measure	Effort	Benefit	Priority
1	Refund the full amount of € 2.000,00 to the bank account in section 6.2	1 transfer	Settles the breach of contract	IMMEDIATE
2	Confirm the refund execution in writing by the stated deadline	1 email	Avoids legal escalation	IMMEDIATE
3	Provide the final source archive and documentation of the delivered codebase	1 handover	Completes the contract record	WITH RE-FUND

I 4.2 Required Actions

- Acknowledge in writing that the deliverable does not meet the agreed scope
- Communicate the planned refund date before the deadline in section 6
- Refrain from assigning further resources until the refund is executed

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Recommended Roadmap

Phase 1: Immediate

Upon receipt of this report (Day 0–1)

- Confirm receipt of this report
- Initiate the refund transfer

Phase 2: Deadline

14 days after receipt (Day 1–14)

- Refund credited to the bank account in section 6.2
- Written confirmation of the transfer

Phase 3: If no refund is received

After the deadline (Day 15+)

- Escalation to German simplified debt collection proceedings (Mahnverfahren) and enforcement against the contractor's German bank account
- This report is retained as evidence of the contract breach

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Refund Request

I 6.1 Refund Demand

Amount	€ 2.000,00
Paid on	May 2026 (confirmed received by the contractor on 2026-05-26)
Deadline	14 days after receipt of this report
Payment reference	Refund – Fullstack Development – ShutUP Forwarder

IMPORTANT

Reason: The € 2.000,00 payment was made for a six-week development engagement with allocated resources (proposal of 2026-05-03; payment confirmed 2026-05-26). The engagement was never performed: the repository shows a short development burst (01-11 July 2026; 30 commits, 25 by a single developer and 5 by the contractor), the core AI features were deliberately left unimplemented (email of 2026-06-15), and the developers promised for August 2026 never materialized – the Friday 07.08.2026 deadline passed without a response; instead of developers, only a manager "not available for hire" was proposed. Despite the client's explicit offer to cooperate and mentor the developers (message of 08.07.2026), no developer was ever presented for a technical interview. The engineering assessment (chapter 3) confirms that the deliverable is a demonstration prototype, not the foundation required for the project. The contract is therefore considered breached, and the full amount of € 2.000,00 is claimed back.

I 6.2 Bank Details for the Refund

Account holder	Skander Ben Abdelmalak
Bank	ING-DiBa
IBAN	DE11 5001 0517 5425 8822 07
BIC / SWIFT	INGDDEFFXXX
VAT ID	DE349348123
Tax No.	42/001/03950

Payment to the account above with the stated payment reference settles the claim in full. The refund claim was assigned to the account holder by Peter Riep; the contractor has been notified of the assignment.



Appendix

I A.1 Rating Methodology

1 – Critical	Acute risk to business operations. Immediate action required.
2 – Deficient	Significant action required. Resolve in the short term.
3 – Adequate	Base requirements met. Optimization potential exists.
4 – Good	Above average. Occasional improvements possible.
5 – Excellent	State of the art. No action required.

I A.2 Evidence

- Codebase assessment report (2026-08-05): static analysis of repository, git history, schema and build pipeline
- Repository commit analysis (GitHub API): 30 commits, 01-11 July 2026 – 25 by a single developer (deployment account 'nikhilforwarder'), 5 by the contractor
- Correspondence log compiled from the complete email and WhatsApp archive (full transcripts available on request)
- Repository: frontend/package.json – production build runs `prisma db push --accept-data-loss`
- Repository: frontend/prisma/schema.prisma – 4 models, free-form status strings, unused pgvector column
- Repository: frontend/src/routes/submit/photos/+page.svelte – photo upload disabled/mock
- Repository: frontend/src/routes/jobs/active/+page.svelte – localStorage mock, ₹5,000 payout, snake_case statuses
- Repository: frontend/src/routes/api/jobs/[job_id]/complete/+server.ts – hardcoded AI damage report
- Repository: frontend/src/routes/submit/route/+page.svelte – character-code price/distance estimation
- Repository: frontend/src/lib/server/ai/brokerAgent.ts – LLM used for deterministic rules

- Repository: frontend/src/routes/+layout.svelte – localStorage role gating
- Correspondence with the contractor regarding the engagement, scope and delivery status

I A.3 Correspondence Log

Date	From	Statement
2026-04-18	Praveen Kulkarni	Shares the forwarder.spikingneurons.com site: 'This is just mockup to attract investors'
2026-05-03	Praveen Kulkarni	Proposes a € 2.000,00 budget for a six-week engagement: minimal product with login screen, basic functionality using mock data, all input forms and types of users
2026-05-07	Praveen Kulkarni	Provides his German account details (IBAN DE09 2007 0024 0089 0566 00, Praveen Baburao Kulkarni) for the payment
2026-05-20	Praveen Kulkarni	States resources already started work; asks to pause if payment does not arrive
2026-05-25/26	Praveen Kulkarni	Confirms receipt of the payment ('I received money from mayur')
2026-06-15	Praveen Kulkarni	Describes the app as a skeleton with business logic and screens; states AI features (image verification, matching) are 'on purpose a blank call'; bidding system is real
2026-06-20	Peter Riep	Formal evaluation of the delivered application: 'there are many mockups that seem to exist solely to demonstrate the UI, but it appears the actual backend work has not yet started'; /jobs page not protected by authentication; deliverables 'do not align with the budget already allocated and transferred'; requests a detailed breakdown of hours and resources
2026-06-23	Praveen Kulkarni	Acknowledges that the client-facing full-stack layer is 'typically built with support from my team'; claims an additional team member was added; states 'I'm not requesting the next payment at this stage; I'd rather make sure we get the foundation right first'

Date	From	Statement
2026-07-01	Praveen Kulkarni	'The deployment ready code is almost done ...' – postpones the meeting due to an Nvidia certification on 5 July; promises a meeting the following week
2026-07-06	Praveen Kulkarni	Provides GitHub repository access (ForwarderDE/Fullstack), deployment URL and test credentials for admin/client/driver roles; proposes a meeting at 11:00 EU time
2026-07-07	Skander Ben Abdelmalak / Praveen Kulkarni	Review meeting held via Google Meet to evaluate the application; the parties agree that developers will be presented in August for the next development phase
2026-07-08	Skander Ben Abdelmalak	WhatsApp: offers to mentor the contractor's developers ('I also don't mind to mentor them for the beginning, but they need intermediate programming skills'); asks for Spring Boot / NestJS-capable engineers
2026-07-11	Praveen Kulkarni	WhatsApp: confirms database and bidding endpoints are functional but admits 'the photo upload is fake ... but then can be implemented when you have clear requirements for AI'
2026-07-18	Praveen Kulkarni	Gap analysis of the EFTI4EU reference implementation: acknowledges the missing eFTI common data model mapping layer, authority access flow, gate ecosystem integration and audit requirements; expects a development resource from the start of next month
2026-08-03	Skander Ben Abdelmalak	WhatsApp: 'your developers are now available again right? can we arrange a call?'
2026-08-03	Praveen Kulkarni	WhatsApp: 'yes it is first day, he is going through new code changes I did ... Once the things are sorted here I will arrange meeting'
2026-08-04	Praveen Kulkarni	Postpones the planned meeting ('one person took off'); announces the handover to 'another experienced person' – an old friend who is 'not available for hire, as he is already very well paid'

Date	From	Statement
2026-08-05	Praveen Kulkarni	Requires a BRD and a decision between shared/dedicated resources; introduces Palash as a coordinator who is 'not available for hire' and manages resources 'as a favor until the project stabilizes'; dedicated developers would require new job advertisements
2026-08-05	Skander Ben Abdelmalak	WhatsApp: demands competent developers for an interview by Friday 2026-08-07; otherwise the contract is considered breached and the refund process for € 2.000,00 is initiated
2026-08-05	Peter Riep	Confirms Skander Ben Abdelmalak has 100% decision-making power and may end the work relationship
2026-08-06	Praveen Kulkarni	Acknowledges: 'I will get back to you Peter'
2026-08-07	—	No response from the contractor to the developer interview demand or the refund deadline

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